

Gradient Bitumen — Conversational Sales Agent

Phase 6 Decision Brief — the natural-language upgrade

One decision is needed before any build: data egress. Framed as value vs effort, not a fix.

Bottom line. v1 is complete and working today. The only meaningful upgrade left (true free-text understanding) hinges on a single question — whether per-turn account/pricing/volume data may leave the platform. Until that is answered, v1 stands on its own; there is nothing to rescue.

(a) Where v1 stands — complete & working

From one natural-language prompt the agent creates the full chain — **Opportunity** → **Order** → **Loading Advice** → **Line** — and auto-submits it for approval (internal PDF + bell alert + approver email). It runs on both the **utility bar** and the **Account page**, asks once for anything missing, confirms before writing, and creates everything in a single all-or-nothing transaction.

- **Guided creation + smart pre-fill** — extracts customer, product, quantity, price, location, load type, dates.
- **Capture-echo** — shows what it understood each turn ("Got it so far: Price ₦450,000 · Qty 30 MT · Location Kano"), so nothing is captured silently.
- **Verified** — 80 automated tests passing; full live UAT passed (create, disambiguation, cancel, links, insight).

(b) Its one real limitation — and it fails safely

Pure rule-based parsing is not full language understanding. Unusual phrasing isn't guessed — it **degrades safely**: the agent simply asks again, and the confirm gate + capture-echo mean no wrong value is ever committed silently. Concrete examples:

- "470k" (shorthand price) → not parsed; the agent keeps the previous value visible and asks — it never invents a price.
- "to Warri" (no delivery cue) → location not captured; the agent asks for the location rather than assuming.
- quantity phrased unusually → standard forms work ("30 MT", "30MT"); anything it can't read confidently falls through to the ask-loop.

(c) The Phase 6 upgrade — and what it changes

Replace the rule-based parser with an LLM that reads free text. By design this touches **Layer 3 only**: the conversation flow, the transactional create, the approval path, the LWC chat panel, and **all 80 tests remain unchanged** — the pluggable parser/classifier seam is already built and shipped. **Effort: small and contained**; the value is a true free-text experience instead of guided prompting.

(d) The one question to answer first

DECISION REQUIRED

Is it acceptable for account names, pricing and volumes to leave the record — sent per turn to a language model? If no, v1 stands as-is (fully functional). If yes, by which route:

Salesforce Models API (recommended)	Stays inside the Salesforce trust boundary. Keeps the privacy conversation short — no new data-processor, commercial pricing does not go off-platform.
Anthropic — direct	A new third-party data-processor relationship. Requires explicit DKloud sign-off to send commercial pricing off-platform (DPA, key management, egress review).